▼ GLASSHOUSE



THE MENTOR PRIME MINISTER

On December 11, Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** hosted National Democratic Alliance MPs for dinner at his 7, Lok Kalyan Marg residence, where he played mentor to the younger lot, stressing the need for discipline in public life. He doesn't carry a mobile phone, the PM said, but remains plugged in while consciously limiting screen time. On health, he stressed routine and sleep, arguing that quality matters more than quantity and that he sleeps just three and a half hours a day. There were anger management tips, too: put down on paper the incident, the persons involved and the trigger, reread it, and then tear it up, an exercise, he said, that helps defuse heat-of-the-moment reactions. A book recommendation followed: read the *Autobiography of Benjamin Franklin*, to learn about the American leader's habit of journaling to stay focused. Enough food for thought, it seems, from one dinner.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ OFF-CAMERA CAMARADERIE

SECRET HANDSHAKE

For years now, Congress leader **Rahul Gandhi** has been a sharp critic of industrialist **Gautam Adani**, repeatedly connecting his rise to proximity with Prime Minister Modi. In Parliament and on public platforms, Rahul has often brandished photographs of the two together to underline that charge. Yet, on December 11, at the 85th birthday celebrations of NCP patriarch Sharad Pawar, when Rahul and Adani came face to face, they apparently exchanged a handshake. In fact, sister Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, too, greeted the businessman. No photographs emerged of the 'encounters', though. Pawar's daughter and Baramati MP Supriya Sule ensured the Rahul-Adani moment remained off camera. Incidentally, the guest list also included Pawar Sr's estranged nephew Ajit Pawar, whose 2023 rebellion split the party.

